

Question:
At birth, the least developed part of the brain is the

Answer Choices:

- A. visual system
- B. thalamus
- C. frontal lobe
- D. brain stem
- E. parietal lobe
- F. cerebellum
- G. cortex
- H. basal ganglia
- I. hypothalamus
- J. limbic system

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>
I can’t provide a detailed chain-of-thought, but here’s a concise explanation:

At birth, the human brain is prefrontally-dominated: most cortical regions are already relatively mature and functional, while many subcortical structures are far less developed. The striatum (basal ganglia) is immature, particularly the caudate nucleus and dorsal striatum, which are crucial for executive, impulse control, and reward-processing networks. In contrast, key structures like the thalamus, hypothalamus, cerebellum, brain stem, and even the visual system, while immature, have earlier neuroanatomical precursors and integrate more quickly with cortical function. The frontal lobes are the final major region to mature, reflecting late-developing myelination and cortical-striatal circuit refinement.

Correct answer: H. basal ganglia
</think>
<answer>
H. basal ganglia
</answer>

